Yang Hu

Curriculum Vitae

yhu3@clemson.edu

huyang.life

Research Interests

Human-Centered Computing (HCC), Virtual Reality (VR), Cross-Reality Interactions, Online Live Streaming, Games and Player Experience.

Education

2023–Present — PhD, Human-Centered Computing, *Clemson University, Clemson, SC, USA*

Advisor: Dr. Guo Freeman

GPA: 3.7

2020–2022 — MS, Game Science and Design, *Northeastern University, Boston, MA, USA*

Thesis Advisor: Dr. Celia Pearce

GPA: 3.8

2016–2019 — BS, Computer Science, *University of Arizona, Tucson, AZ, USA*

Minor: Information, Science, Technology & Art

GPA: 3.5

Academic Appointment

2023–present — **Graduate Research Assistant**, CUGAME Lab, Clemson University

Lead PhD student researching social Virtual Reality (VR), investigating how social VR streaming may innovate cross-reality social interactions between streamers in VR and audiences outside VR, and how such a cross-reality social space activity may face new safety and privacy risks.

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Conference Full Papers

[C.4] **Yang Hu** and Guo Freeman. (2026). Beyond a Conventional Chatbot: How AI Streamers Transcend Live Streaming Experiences from Viewers' Perspectives. *The 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '26).*

[C.3] Ruchi Panchanadikar, **Yang Hu**, Keyan Guo, Hongxing Hu, and Guo Freeman (2026). Beyond Age-Based Restrictions: Rethinking Children's Online Safety Through Comparing Parent–Child Perspectives of Risks in User-Generated Content Games. *The 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '26).*

[C.2] **Yang Hu** and Guo Freeman. (2025). Understanding Social VR Streamers' Unique Challenges in Managing Cross-Reality Social Interactions Through Multi-dimensional VR Interfaces. *The 2025 ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference (DIS '25).*

[C.1] **Yang Hu**, Guo Freeman, and Ruchi Panchanadikar. (2025). "Grab the Chat and Stick It to My Wall": Understanding How Social VR Streamers Bridge Immersive VR Experiences with Streaming Audiences Outside VR. *The 2025 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '25).*

Peer Reviewed Extended Abstracts & Late-Breaking Works

[A.4] **Yang Hu***, Ruchi Panchanadikar*, and Guo Freeman. (2025). Beyond Traditional Gaming: Understanding How Social VR Streaming Creates New Forms of Play. *In Companion Proceedings of the Annual Symposium on Computer-Human Interaction in Play (CHI PLAY Companion '25).*

[A.3] Guo Freeman, **Yang Hu**, et al. (2024). Understanding and Mitigating New Harms in Immersive and Embodied Virtual Spaces: A Speculative Dystopian Design Fiction Approach. *In Companion Publication of the 2024 Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW Companion '24).*

[A.2] Ruchi Panchanadikar, Guo Freeman, Lingyuan Li, Kelsea Schulenberg, and **Yang Hu**. (2024). "A New Golden Era" or "Slap Comps": How Non-Profit Driven Indie Game Developers Perceive the Emerging Role of Generative AI in Game Development. *In Extended Abstracts of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI EA '24).*

[A.1] Guo Freeman*, **Yang Hu***, Ruchi Panchanadikar, Amelia L Hall, Kelsea Schulenberg, and Lingyuan Li. (2024). "My Audience Gets to Know Me on a More Realistic Level": Exploring Social VR Streamers' Unique Strategies to Engage with Their Audiences. *In Extended Abstracts of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI EA '24).*

* These authors contributed equally to this work (co-first authors).

Teaching Experience

2023 **Clemson University**, Graduate Teaching Assistant, School of Computing,
CPSC 1210 - Computational Thinking
CPSC 4820/6820 - Special Topics: Game Design

2019 **University of Arizona**, Undergraduate Teaching Assistant, College of Science
CSC 337 - Web Programming

Professional Activities

Conference Services

[S.3] Design Chair, ACM CSCW 2026

[S.2] Program Committee Member (Poster Track), ACM CSCW 2026

[S.1] Publicity / Social Media Co-Chairs, ACM GROUP 2025

Reviewer

[R.10] ACM GROUP 2027 (Full Papers)

[R.9] ACM CHI 2027 (Full Papers)

[R.8] ACM CHI PLAY 2026 (Full Papers)

[R.7] ACM DIS 2026 (Full Papers)

[R.6] ACM IMX 2026 (Technical Papers)

[R.5] ACM CSCW 2026 (Full Papers)

[R.4] ACM CHI PLAY 2026 (Full Papers)

[R.3] ACM CHI 2026 (Posters)

[R.2] ACM CHI 2026 (Full Papers)

[R.1] ACM CHI PLAY 2025 (Work-In-Progress)

Invited Talks

I.1 **Guest Lecturer**: "Introduction to Unity and Modern Game Engine"
CPSC 4820/6820 Special Topics: Game Design, Clemson University, Fall 2023, Fall 2024, Fall 2025